

BRACHYCHITON

glossy, deep green leaves are chartreuse when young. In spring–summer, bears panicles of saucer-shaped, cream or greenish-white flowers with red, purple or yellow throats. Z9–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

BRACHYGLOTTIS

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and trees, herbaceous perennials, and climbers, grown for their bold foliage and daisylike flower heads. Grow in well-drained soil in full sun. Water potted plants freely in summer, moderately at all other times. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in late summer.

B. compacta, syn. *Senecio compactus*. Evergreen, bushy, dense shrub. H 3ft (1m), S 6ft (2m). Bears small, ovate, white-edged, dark green leaves, white below, and daisy-like, bright yellow flowers in clustered heads from mid- to late summer. Feltlike, white hairs cover the shoots. Z9–10
B. Dunedin Group, syn. *Senecio* Dunedin Hybrids, *S. greyi* of gardens, *S. laxifolius* of gardens. Evergreen, bushy, mound-forming shrubs. H 5ft (1.5m), S 6ft (2m). Obovate to elliptic, often wavy-margined, mid- to dark green leaves, are white-hairy at first, then hairless. Loose clusters of daisylike, yellow flower heads are borne from summer to fall. Z9–10. ‘**Sunshine**’ illus. p.161.

B. laxifolia, syn. *Senecio laxifolius*. Evergreen, bushy, spreading shrub. H 3ft (1m), S 6ft (2m). Ovate, gray-white leaves become dark green. Bears large clusters of daisylike, golden-yellow flower heads in summer. Z8–10

B. monroi, syn. *Senecio monroi*, illus. p.161.

B. repanda (Pukapuka, Rangiora). Evergreen, bushy shrub or tree. H 10ft (3m), S 10ft (3m) or more. Upright when young, with robust, downy, white stems and veined leaves, that are white beneath. Bears fragrant, white flower heads in summer. Z12–15

B. rotundifolia, syn. *Senecio reinoldii*, *S. rotundifolius*. Evergreen, rounded, dense shrub. H and S 3ft (1m). Produces rounded, leathery, glossy leaves, dark green above, white-felted below, and tiny, yellow flower heads from early to midsummer. In mild coastal areas will withstand salt winds. Z9–10

B. WALBERTON’S SILVER DORMOUSE (‘**Walbrach**’). Evergreen, compact, bushy shrub. H 3ft (90cm), S 4ft (1.2m). Has ovate, hairy, silvery-gray, white-edged leaves, white beneath. A profusion of yellow flower heads with conspicuous ray-florets are borne in loose panicles, to 5in (12cm) across, in summer. Z6–10

BRACHYSCOME

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of annuals and perennials, grown for their daisylike flower heads and very variable, often finely divided foliage. Requires sun, a sheltered position, and rich, well-drained soil. Pinch out growing shoots of young plants to encourage a bushy habit. Propagate by seed sown under glass in spring or outdoors in late spring.
B. iberidifolia (Swan River daisy). Moderately fast-growing, thin-stemmed, bushy annual. H to 18in (45cm), S 14in

(35cm). Has deeply cut leaves and small, fragrant, daisylike flowers, usually blue but also pink, mauve, purple or white, in summer and early fall. Z10–11. **Bravo Series** has white, blue or violet flower heads with black centers. ‘**Little Missy**’ is compact, and bears lilac-blue flower heads with yellow centers.

Bracteantha. See *Xerochrysum*.

BRASILIOPUNTIA

CACTACEAE

Genus of one species of treelike perennial cactus, related to *Opuntia*. Eventually flowers and fruits when mature. Where marginally hardy, protect from frost and keep dry in winter. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or root stem segments in spring or summer.
B. brasiliensis, syn. *Opuntia brasiliensis*. Treelike, perennial cactus. H 18ft (5.5m), S 10ft (3m). Has a cylindrical, green stem bearing bright green branches of flattened, ovate, spiny segments. Sheds 2–3-year-old side branches. Abundant shallowly saucer-shaped, yellow flowers, 1½in (4cm) across, are borne in spring–summer on plants over 2ft (60cm) tall, followed by small, yellow fruits. Z8–11 (min. 37–41°F/3–5°C)

Brasiliorchis. See *Maxillaria*.

Brassaia. See *Schefflera*.

BRASSAVOLA

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.
B. nodosa (Lady-of-the-night; illus. p.466). Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for an intermediate greenhouse. H and S 7in (18cm). Narrow-petaled, pale green flowers, 2in (5cm) across and each with a white lip, are borne, 1–3 to a stem, in spring; they are fragrant at night. Leaves, 7in (18cm) long, are thick and cylindrical. Best grown on a bark slab. Provide good light in summer. Z11–12 (min. 55°F/13°C, max. 86°F/30°C)

BRASSIA

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.
B. aurantiaca, syn. *Ada aurantiaca* (illus. p.467). Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for a cool greenhouse. H 9in (23cm). Bears sprays of tubular, orange flowers, 1in (25cm) long, in early spring. Has narrowly ovate leaves, 4in (10cm) long. Needs shade in summer. Z9–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

BRASSICA

BRASSICACEAE/CRUCIFERAE

Genus of annuals and evergreen biennials and perennials. Most are edible vegetables (such as cabbages and kales), but forms of *B. oleracea* are grown for their ornamental foliage. Grow in sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Lime-rich soil is preferable, but not essential. Propagate by seed sown outdoors in spring or under glass in early spring. Prone to club root.
B. oleracea cultivars (Ornamental cabbage). Moderately fast-growing, evergreen, rounded biennial, grown as

an annual. H and S 1–1½ft (30–45cm). Has heads of large, often crinkled leaves, in combinations of red/green, white/pink, pink/green. Do not allow to flower. Z7–11. **Northern Lights Series** illus. p.306.

× **Brassocattleya** × **B. Mount Adams**.

See × *Rhyncholaeliocattleya* Mount Adams.

× **Brassolaeliocattleya Hetherington Horace ‘Coronation’**. See

× *Rhyncholaeliocattleya* Hetherington Horace ‘Coronation’.

× **Brassolaeliocattleya St Helier**. See × *Rhyncholaeliocattleya* St Helier.

Bravoa geminiflora. See *Polianthes geminiflora*.

BREYNIA

PHYLLANTHACEAE/EUPHORBIACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and trees, grown for their foliage. Requires full light or partial shade, and fertile, well-drained soil. Water potted plants freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. Cut back large bushes hard after flowering. Propagate by greenwood or semiripe cuttings in summer. Whitefly, red spider mite and mealy bug may be troublesome.
B. disticha, syn. *B. nivos*a, *Phyllanthus nivosus* (Snow bush). Evergreen, well-branched shrub with slender stems. H 3ft (1m) or more, S 2–3ft (60–100cm). Leaves are green with white marbling. Tiny, greenish flowers, borne intermittently, have no petals. Z14–15. (min. 59°F/15°C)
‘Roseopicta’ H and S to 3ft (1m). Has broadly ovate, green leaves variably bordered and splashed with white and flushed pink. Insignificant, petalless flowers are borne in spring–summer.
B. nivosa. See *B. disticha*.

Bridgesia spicata. See *Ercilla volubilis*.

BRIGGSIA

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of evergreen perennials, grown for their rosettes of hairy leaves. Needs shade and peaty soil, with plenty of moisture in summer, and good air circulation in winter. Protect against damp in winter. Propagate by seed in spring.
B. muscicola. Evergreen, basal-rosetted perennial. H 2–3in (5–8cm), S to 6in (15cm). Leaves are ovate, silver-haired and pale green. Arching flower stems bear loose clusters of tubular, pale yellow flowers, with protruding tips, in early summer. Best grown in an alpine house. Z12–15

BRIMEURA

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of spring-flowering bulbs, similar to miniature bluebells, cultivated for their attractive flowers. Suitable for rock gardens and shrub borders. Requires partial shade and prefers humus-rich, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in fall or by division in late summer.
B. amethystina, syn. *Hyacinthus amethystinus*, illus. p.419. **var. alba** is a bulbous perennial. H 4–8in (10–20cm), S 2in (5cm). Has linear, channelled, bright green leaves, 4–12in (10–30cm) long.

Loose, slender racemes of tubular-bell-shaped, white flowers are produced in spring. Z5–9

Brittonastrum mexicanum. See *Agastache mexicana*.

BRIZA

Quaking grass

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.

B. maxima (Greater quaking grass). Robust, tuft-forming, annual grass. H 1½–2ft (45–60cm), S 10in (25cm). Mid-green leaves are mainly basal. Produces loose panicles of 7–20 pendent, purplish-green spikelets, in early summer, that dry particularly well for winter decoration. Self seeds readily. Z5–8

B. media (Common quaking grass). Evergreen, tuft-forming, rhizomatous, perennial grass. H 2–3ft (60–90cm), S 1ft (30cm). Mid-green leaves are mainly basal. In summer, produces open panicles of up to 30 pendent, purplish-brown spikelets that dry well for winter decoration. Z4–11

BRODIAEA

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of mainly spring-flowering bulbs with colorful flowers produced in loose heads on leafless stems. Needs a sheltered, sunny situation and light, well-drained soil. Dies down in summer. Propagate in fall by seed or in late summer and fall by freely produced offsets.
B. californica. Early summer-flowering bulb. H 20in (50cm), S 3in (8cm). Bears large umbels of up to 12 widely funnel-shaped, violet, lilac, or pink flowers on long stalks. Z6–10

B. capitata. See *Dichelostemma capitatum*.

B. congesta. See *Dichelostemma congestum*.

B. coronaria, syn. *B. grandiflora*. Late spring- to early summer-flowering bulb. H 2–10in (5–25cm), S 2in (5cm). Long, narrow, semierect, basal leaves die down by flowering time. Leafless stems each carry a loose head of erect, funnel-shaped, violet-blue flowers on long, slender stalks. Z8–10

B. grandiflora. See *B. coronaria*.

B. hyacinthina. See *Triteleia hyacinthina*.

B. ida-maia. See *Dichelostemma ida-maia*.

B. ixioides. See *Triteleia ixioides*.

B. lactea. See *Triteleia hyacinthina*.

B. laxa. See *Triteleia laxa*. ‘**Queen Fabiola**’ see *Triteleia laxa*

‘Koningin Fabiola’.

B. lutea. See *Triteleia ixioides*.

B. peduncularis. See *Triteleia peduncularis*.

B. pulchella. See *Dichelostemma capitatum*.

BROMELIA

BROMELIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, rosette-forming perennials, grown for their overall appearance. Needs full light and well-drained soil. Water moderately in summer, sparingly at other times. Propagate by